Software Testing viva: student scripts

SE1030 | one script per student | 1 to 1 minute 30 seconds

How the recording works

- The examiner asks the question below, then you answer in your own voice using your script. You may glance at the script, but try to say it naturally.
- Treat it like a short presentation: greet the audience, talk to the camera, and say thank you at the end. The greeting and the thank-you are part of your script.
- Sit in front of the camera with your face clearly visible and nobody else in the picture. Do not draw anything.
- Practise your script once or twice first. Aim for the time written on your page.
- Do exactly the style described on your page. Each student is deliberately different, so please do not copy another student.
- Keep to your script. Do not add extra facts that are not in it.

The question asked to every student

> *Explain unit, integration and system testing, including performance and security testing. Then tell me the difference between smoke and sanity testing, and between black-box and white-box testing, and what regression testing is for.*

Student 01

Complete and fluent

Your style: The strongest answer. Calm, clear, steady pace.

Aim for between 1:00 and 1:30. Most people finish this script in about 1:17.

How to deliver it

- Speak at a normal, steady pace.
- Look at the camera, keep a relaxed expression, no fillers.
- Say every sentence in full.

Your script

Good morning, everyone, and thank you for listening. Today I would like to talk about software testing, and I will go through it step by step. Let me start with the levels. Unit testing checks the smallest piece of code, such as a single function, on its own. Developers usually run these tests while they write the code, so mistakes are found early. After that comes integration testing, which checks that those units work correctly together, especially the data passed between them. Then system testing checks the whole finished system against its requirements. It includes performance testing, which measures speed and stability when many people use the system, and security testing, which looks for weaknesses such as weak authentication or injection attacks. Moving on, smoke testing is a quick, shallow check on a new build, just to see whether the main functions work at all, while sanity testing is a narrow check after a small fix, to confirm that exact change works. Next, black-box testing checks behaviour from the outside, using inputs and outputs, with techniques like equivalence partitioning and boundary value analysis, while white-box testing looks inside the code. To finish, regression testing reruns earlier tests after any change, to make sure nothing that used to work has broken. Thank you very much.

Student 02

Strong content, but rushed

Your style: Knows everything, but talks far too fast and runs sentences together.

Aim for between 1:00 and 1:30. Most people finish this script in about 1:03.

How to deliver it

- Speak fast, almost without breathing, but still clearly.
- Keep your face on camera. Hardly any pauses.
- Do not add fillers. The problem is speed only.

Your script

Hi everyone, thanks for having me. I will be quick because there is a lot to cover. So testing has levels, unit testing is one small piece of code tested on its own, usually by the developer so mistakes show up early, then integration testing is checking the pieces work together and pass data properly between them, and system testing is the whole system against the requirements, and that includes performance testing which is speed and stability when lots of people use it at once, and security testing which hunts for weaknesses like weak login or injection attacks, and then smoke testing is the quick shallow check on a new build to see if the main things work before anyone spends more time on it, sanity testing is the small focused check after a bug fix to confirm that one change works, black-box is testing from the outside with inputs and outputs and using equivalence partitioning to group the inputs, white-box is looking at the code inside and checking the paths through it, and finally regression testing is running the old tests again after any change so nothing that worked before gets broken, usually automated so it can be repeated quickly. So that is basically everything, and I hope that makes sense. Thank you.

Student 03

Hesitant and uncertain

Your style: Mostly correct, but full of hedges, fillers and long silences.

Aim for between 1:00 and 1:30. Most people finish this script in about 1:29.

How to deliver it

- Say the "um" and "uh" where they are written, as people naturally do, and let a short silence happen now and then.
- Sound unsure. Look at the camera, but let your face look worried.

Your script

Um, hello everyone, and thank you for listening. So, uh, today I am going to talk about software testing, which is something every project needs, because nobody wants to give the customer a program that breaks. So, first, unit testing is, um, testing one small part of the code on its own, like a single function. I think the developer usually does that while writing the code, so the mistakes are found early. Then integration testing is, uh, checking that the different parts work together, so the data passes between them properly. After that, system testing is testing the whole system, and that includes performance testing, which is, sort of, how fast and stable it is when lots of people use it, and also security testing, looking for weak points, like somebody getting in without a password. Next, smoke testing is, um, a quick check on a new build to see if the main things work, before we spend more time on it, and sanity testing is a small check after a fix, just to confirm that one change works. Black-box testing is when you test from the outside, without seeing the code, only looking at what goes in and what comes out. And, uh, finally, regression testing is testing again after changes, so that nothing that worked before is broken. So, um, that is what I wanted to say. Okay, thank you very much.

Student 04

Levels only

Your style: Answers the first half of the question well and skips the rest.

Aim for between 1:00 and 1:30. Most people finish this script in about 1:24.

How to deliver it

- Steady, flat, serious voice.
- Stop after regression testing as if that was the whole answer. Do not mention smoke, sanity, black-box or white-box.

Your script

Hello everyone, and thank you for coming. Today I want to explain the levels of software testing, and I will keep it simple, because the levels are the best place to start. First of all, unit testing means testing the smallest parts of the software, like one function or one class, on their own. For example, if there is a function that adds two numbers, a unit test checks that it gives the right answer. Developers write and run these tests while they are writing the code, and they are quick to run, so mistakes are found early. Second, integration testing is done after that. It checks that different modules work together properly and that the data passes between them correctly. If two modules disagree about the format of the data, this is where the problem shows up. Third, system testing tests the complete system as a whole against the requirements that were agreed at the start. It is normally done after integration testing is finished, in an environment that is close to the real one. And finally, regression testing is used whenever the software changes. The old tests are run again to confirm that existing features still work after the change, and it is usually automated, so it can be repeated quickly. Together these levels build confidence step by step, starting small and finishing with the whole system. That is what I wanted to share today. Thank you for listening, and I hope it was useful.

Student 05

Confident but wrong

Your style: Sounds sure of himself or herself, but several facts are reversed.

Aim for between 1:00 and 1:30. Most people finish this script in about 1:22.

How to deliver it

- Bright, confident, energetic voice. Smile.
- Say the wrong facts exactly as written, with total confidence.

Your script

Good afternoon, everybody. I am very happy to be here, because this is a topic I know really well, and I have explained it to many friends. Let me begin. Unit testing is when the customer tries the whole product before they accept it. Everybody knows that. Integration testing is testing a single function by itself, nothing more than that, so it is very quick to do. Moving on, system testing means testing the complete system, and performance testing is about how fast it runs, and it is done by the developers on their own laptops, usually in one afternoon. Security testing checks for weaknesses, and it is done once, at the very end of the project. Next, smoke testing is the deep, complete test of every feature. It takes days, because it covers everything, while sanity testing is the very quick check that you do at the end. Black-box testing means you read the code line by line to find the problems, and white-box testing means you only use the screen and never see the code at all. I am completely sure about that, because we always do it this way in my team. Finally, regression testing is testing only the brand new features that were just added, because the old ones never need to be checked again once they have passed. So that is the full answer, and I am very happy with it. Thank you very much for listening.

Student 06

Slow, quiet and trailing off

Your style: Soft, slow voice, long gaps, sentences that fade away.

Aim for between 1:00 and 1:30. Most people finish this script in about 1:24.

How to deliver it

- Speak quietly and slowly, about half your normal speed.
- Let your voice fade a little at the end of each sentence, and leave a natural gap before the next one.
- Keep your face on camera.

Your script

Hello, everyone. Thank you for letting me speak. Today I will talk a little about software testing, and I will try to explain it slowly. Unit testing is testing a small part of the code, by itself. It is done by the developer, I think, while writing the code, so that mistakes are found early. Next, integration testing is when the parts are put together and we check that they work, and that the data goes from one part to the other. After that, system testing is the whole system, against what it should do, from the beginning until the end. Security testing is finding weak points, so that other people cannot get in and see the private data. And regression testing is when we change something, we test again, so the old things still work. This is important, because a small change can break something that was fine before. That is what I remember. I know there are some more types, but I cannot say them clearly now. I am sorry. Thank you for listening, and thank you for your patience.

Student 07

Explains with an example

Your style: Warm, expressive storyteller who explains everything through a login page.

Aim for between 1:00 and 1:30. Most people finish this script in about 1:16.

How to deliver it

- Natural, friendly voice, smile, and use small hand gestures if you like.

Your script

Hello everyone, it is lovely to be here. Today I would like to explain software testing, and I will use a login page as my example. Let me start with unit testing, which is checking just the login function on its own. Then integration testing is checking that the login works together with the database. After that, system testing is checking the whole app from start to finish. Performance testing is seeing what happens when thousands of people log in at the same time, and security testing is trying wrong passwords and injection attacks to see if the login can be broken. Now, smoke testing is when a new build arrives and we quickly open the app and log in, just to see that it basically works, and sanity testing is after we fix the password reset bug, when we check only that reset button. Black-box testing is testing as a user, just typing and clicking, and a good technique there is boundary value analysis, for example trying a password that is exactly the minimum length, one character shorter, and one character longer. White-box testing is looking at the login code itself. To finish, regression testing is running all the login tests again after every change. Thank you, I hope that was clear.

Student 08

Very short and vague

Your style: Barely remembers anything and says so.

Aim for between 1:00 and 1:30. Most people finish this script in about 1:24.

How to deliver it

- Slow and unsure. Take your time between sentences.
- Look at the camera, but look a little lost.

Your script

Hello everyone. Um, thank you for giving me the chance to speak. I am a little nervous, but I will try my best. So, today the topic is software testing. Testing is important, because we must test the software before we give it to the customer. If it has mistakes, the customer will not be happy and the company will lose money, and sometimes people lose their jobs. So every team should do testing, and it should be done carefully, and not in a hurry at the end of the project. There are different types of testing. There is unit testing, that is testing a small unit, a small part of the program, like one piece at a time. And there is regression testing, that is testing again after a change, so that the old things still work. And black-box testing, I think that is testing without looking at the code, you just use the program and see what happens. I do not really remember the other types, we learned them last semester, and the lecturer showed us a long list. I know they are all important, but I would need to look at my notes. Maybe next time I can explain them better, because I know I did not answer everything today. Sorry, that is all I can say. Thank you for your time, and thank you for listening, everyone.

Student 09

Reads a flat list

Your style: Reads one-line definitions in a flat voice, with no explanation.

Aim for between 1:00 and 1:30. Most people finish this script in about 1:18.

How to deliver it

- Read it from your phone propped at camera level, so your face stays towards the camera.
- Flat, monotone voice, no smile. Leave a small gap after each definition.

Your script

Good morning, everyone. Thank you for coming. This is my presentation on software testing. The topic of my presentation is the types of software testing. I will list the types one by one, and I will read the definition of each one. The first type is unit testing: testing individual units, one at a time. The second type is integration testing: testing combined units together. The third type is system testing: testing the whole system at once. The fourth type is smoke testing: a quick test of the new build. The fifth type is sanity testing: a test after a small change. The sixth type is black-box testing: testing without looking at the code. The seventh type is white-box testing: testing with the code visible. The eighth type is regression testing: testing again after changes are made. Those are the types of testing that I was asked about. I have listed all of them in the order that I learned them, and I have read the definition of every type. That is my answer, and that is the end of my presentation. Thank you very much for your time and for your attention. If you have any questions, please ask me now.